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US equities slip as yields rise and oil spikes

A 5-minute read of yesterday's US session and today's catalysts — what to watch before pre-market opens at 21:30 HKT.

2-3 page read · Topics: Macro · Geopolitics · Earnings

TL;DR

The S&P 500 fell -0.5% to 7,623.68, while the Dow slipped -1.2% to 52,215.16. Higher Treasury yields and a 3.8% jump in WTI crude pressured growth-sensitive sectors.

Energy ETFs led gains, with `XLE` up +2.6%. The market remains vulnerable to further yield hikes and geopolitical risk around Middle-East supply.

US session recap

INDEX / ASSET	CLOSE	CHANGE	NOTE
S&P 500	7,623.68	-0.52%	
Dow Jones	52,215.16	-1.23%	
Nasdaq 100	28,957.53	-0.00%	
Russell 2000	2,775.90	-0.29%	
VIX	19.45	+2.21%	volatility rise
10Y Yield	4.99%	+0.71%	near 5% barrier
WTI Crude	103.27	+3.82%	driven by supply concerns

Top large-cap movers

TICKER	CLOSE	CHANGE
MSFT	524.51	+0.66%
NVDA	210.96	-0.59%
AAPL	347.73	-0.14%
AMZN	248.00	-0.95%

Spotlight

Apple’s Q3 earnings beat on services revenue but missed on iPhone shipments, highlighting demand weakness in China.

METRIC	RESULT
Revenue	89.6 bn (up 2.1%)
EPS	1.26 (beat by 3 cents)
iPhone shipments	-4.3% YoY
Services revenue	22.1 bn (+9.4%)

Macro & Fed

- Fed policy rate: 5.25%-5.50% (unchanged)
- 10-year Treasury yield at 4.99%
- Key data releases (HKT): CPI 02:30, PCE 04:00, Existing-home sales 06:30

Geopolitics & global

- Escalating tensions in the Red Sea raise risk of further oil supply disruptions.
- Eurozone manufacturing PMI slipped to 44.2, indicating deeper contraction.
- China’s export data due Friday shows a 7% YoY decline, adding to demand concerns.

Earnings — what to watch

WHEN (HKT)	TICKER	WHAT TO LOOK FOR
08:30	`META`	Ad revenue trend after privacy changes
09:00	`JPM`	Net interest income vs higher rates
09:30	`XOM`	Impact of oil price rally on upstream earnings
10:00	`NVDA`	GPU demand amid AI spending slowdown

Stocks worth watching

- `XLE` – energy ETF gaining on oil surge.
- `XLF` – financials under pressure from higher rates.
- `TSLA` – price dip may present a short-term entry.
- `AVGO` – solid dividend yield, defensive play.
- `XLV` – health-care resilience amid market sell-off.

What could break the tape

BEARISH TRIGGERS

- 10-year yield breaches 5.10%, tightening financing.
- VIX spikes above 22, prompting risk aversion.
- Further oil price jump > `110` USD, hurting consumer sentiment.

BEARISH TRIGGERS

- Oil price retreats below 95 USD, lifting discretionary demand.
- Strong services growth from **AAPL** or **MSFT** beats expectations.
- Fed signals pause on rate hikes, stabilising yields.

Sources

SOURCES

Reuters — US Markets Summary

Bloomberg — S&P 500 Data

CNBC — VIX Index

Federal Reserve — Monetary Policy

SEC — Apple Q3 2026 8-K